



BE READY.

Pre-season

Your sessions

Explosiveness

Program

Pre-season

Duration

8 weeks

Session

45 to 60 min

Place

Gym

For personal use only, do not share. This program is for people in good health: if you feel pain, have an injury or are in doubt, stop and ask a health professional for advice.

Your goal

You chose a single goal: every session gives it two blocks, and the focus changes over the weeks. What you worked on before stays in the sessions, with fewer sets, so you do not lose it.

Explosiveness

In handball, the decisive actions last less than 3 seconds: a first step to break into a gap, a change of direction to beat your opponent, a sprint back on defence.

- **Speed:** moving fast over a few metres.
- **Acceleration:** reaching your top speed as early as possible.
- **Changes of direction and agility:** braking, reorienting and setting off again without losing time.

The golden rules

- **Every rep flat out**, or nearly: quality matters more than quantity.
- **Recover fully** between reps: it is normal to wait.
- **Stop the set** if you slow down or your landings get heavy.
- Non-slip floor and shoes that hold your feet well.

Level 1: no more than **60 jumps** per session. Level 2: 80. Level 3: 100. Every landing counts as a jump.



Important: watch each exercise's animation before doing it. Tap the eye next to its name. The animation shows what the text cannot: the exact position, the direction of the movement, the rhythm and the footwork. Do not just read the program, especially for an exercise you do not know: this is what makes every session effective and safe.

How to read your sessions

- Every session is written out in full, in order: do the steps from top to bottom.
- "2-4 × 8": 2 sets at level 1, 3 at level 2, 4 at level 3, of 8 reps. "2-3 × 8": 2 sets at levels 1 and 2, 3 at level 3.
- The number in front of each exercise refers to its illustrated sheet, at the end of this document.
- If you do not know your level, read the guide again, page "Choosing your level".

Weeks 1-2 · Getting started

Get your body used to effort again and learn the movements. Effort 5-6 out of 10.

Explosiveness only: the focus is on jumps and landings, speed comes in gently.

Session A

1 WARM-UP

10-12 min

1	Light jog and running drills	3 min	
2	 Forward lunge with trunk rotation	6 per side	
3	 Walking hip opener	8 per side	
4	 Glute bridge	2 × 10	15 s
5	 Plank	2 × 20 s	15 s
6	 Single-leg balance	2 × 20 s per leg	
7	 Small jump, stable landing	2 × 5	20 s
8	Progressive accelerations	3 runs	walk back

2 EXPLOSIVENESS · JUMPS AND LANDINGS

15-20 min

9	 Stable landing (snap-down)	2-4 × 5	45 s
10	 Pogos	2-3 × 10	45 s
11	 Squat jump	2-3 × 5	60 s

3 EXPLOSIVENESS · SPEED AND CHANGES OF DIRECTION

15-20 min

8	Progressive accelerations (15 m at 80 %)	4 runs	walk back
12	 10 m starts (at 80 %)	3-4 runs	60 s

4 CORE AND PREVENTION

5-8 min

5	 Plank	2-4 × 30 s	30 s
13	 Side plank	2-3 × 20 s per side	20 s
14	 Nordic hamstring curl	2-3 × 4	60 s

5 COOL-DOWN

5 min

2 minutes of walking, then light stretches of 20 to 30 seconds, without forcing: hip flexors, quads, hamstrings, calves, chest and shoulders.

Session B

1 WARM-UP

10-12 min

1	Light jog and running drills	3 min	
2	 Forward lunge with trunk rotation	6 per side	
3	 Walking hip opener	8 per side	
4	 Glute bridge	2 × 10	15 s
5	 Plank	2 × 20 s	15 s
6	 Single-leg balance	2 × 20 s per leg	
7	 Small jump, stable landing	2 × 5	20 s
8	Progressive accelerations	3 runs	walk back

2 EXPLOSIVENESS · JUMPS AND LANDINGS

15-20 min

15	 Lateral bound with stable landing	2-3 × 4 per leg	45 s
16	 Single-leg landing	2 × 4 per leg	30 s
10	 Pogos	2 × 10	45 s

3 EXPLOSIVENESS · SPEED AND CHANGES OF DIRECTION

15-20 min

17	 Braking	3-5 runs	60 s
18	 5-10-5 shuttle (at 80 %)	2-3 runs	90 s

4 CORE AND PREVENTION

5-8 min

19	 Dead bug	2-3 × 8 per side	30 s
20	 Y-T-W	2-3 × 8	30 s
21	 Balance with a ball	2 × 30 s per leg	20 s

5 COOL-DOWN

5 min

2 minutes of walking, then light stretches of 20 to 30 seconds, without forcing: hip flexors, quads, hamstrings, calves, chest and shoulders.

Session C

1 WARM-UP

10-12 min

1	Light jog and running drills	3 min	
2	 Forward lunge with trunk rotation	6 per side	
3	 Walking hip opener	8 per side	
4	 Glute bridge	2 × 10	15 s
5	 Plank	2 × 20 s	15 s
6	 Single-leg balance	2 × 20 s per leg	
7	 Small jump, stable landing	2 × 5	20 s
8	Progressive accelerations	3 runs	walk back

2 EXPLOSIVENESS · JUMPS AND LANDINGS

15-20 min

11	 Squat jump	2-3 × 5	60 s
22	 Box jump	2-3 × 4	75 s
9	 Stable landing (snap-down)	2 × 5	45 s

3 EXPLOSIVENESS · SPEED AND CHANGES OF DIRECTION

15-20 min

12	 10 m starts (at 90 %)	4-6 runs	60 s
23	 Reactive starts	3-4 runs	60 s

4 CORE AND PREVENTION

5-8 min

24	 Single-leg glute bridge	2-3 × 10 per leg	30 s
25	 Copenhagen plank (knee version)	2-3 × 15 s per side	30 s
26	 Shoulder external rotation	2-3 × 12 per arm	30 s

5 COOL-DOWN

5 min

2 minutes of walking, then light stretches of 20 to 30 seconds, without forcing: hip flexors, quads, hamstrings, calves, chest and shoulders.

Week after week, you can add the optional bonus session:

Session D (bonus, optional) - 20 min

1 WARM-UP

10 min

1	Light jog and running drills	3 min	
2	 Forward lunge with trunk rotation	6 per side	
3	 Walking hip opener	8 per side	
4	 Glute bridge	2 × 10	15 s
5	 Plank	2 × 20 s	15 s
6	 Single-leg balance	2 × 20 s per leg	
7	 Small jump, stable landing	2 × 5	20 s
8	Progressive accelerations	3 runs	walk back

2 PREVENTION AND MOBILITY

10 min

5	 Plank	2 × 30 s	30 s
13	 Side plank	2 × 20 s per side	20 s
14	 Nordic hamstring curl	2 × 3	60 s
27	 90/90 hip mobility	1 × 8 per side	
28	 Ankle mobility at the wall	1 × 10 per side	
29	 Upper back rotation	1 × 8 per side	

Weeks 3-5 - Building up

Increase the loads gradually. Week 5 is the heaviest. Effort 7-8 out of 10.

Explosiveness only: the jumps get more demanding (bounds, box), the sprints go up in intensity.

Session A

1 WARM-UP

10-12 min

1	Light jog and running drills	3 min	
2	 Forward lunge with trunk rotation	6 per side	
3	 Walking hip opener	8 per side	
4	 Glute bridge	2 × 10	15 s
5	 Plank	2 × 20 s	15 s
6	 Single-leg balance	2 × 20 s per leg	
7	 Small jump, stable landing	2 × 5	20 s
8	Progressive accelerations	3 runs	walk back

2 EXPLOSIVENESS · JUMPS AND SPRING

15-20 min

11	 Squat jump	3-4 × 5	60 s
30	 Broad jumps and triple jump (broad jumps)	3 × 3	75 s
10	 Pogos	2 × 15	45 s

3 EXPLOSIVENESS · SPEED AND CHANGES OF DIRECTION

15-20 min

12	 10 m starts	5-6 runs	75 s
18	 5-10-5 shuttle	2-4 runs	90 s

4 CORE AND PREVENTION

5-8 min

5	 Plank	2-4 × 30 s	30 s
13	 Side plank	2-3 × 20 s per side	20 s
14	 Nordic hamstring curl	2-3 × 4	60 s

5 COOL-DOWN

5 min

2 minutes of walking, then light stretches of 20 to 30 seconds, without forcing: hip flexors, quads, hamstrings, calves, chest and shoulders.

Session B

1 WARM-UP

10-12 min

1	Light jog and running drills	3 min	
2	 Forward lunge with trunk rotation	6 per side	
3	 Walking hip opener	8 per side	
4	 Glute bridge	2 × 10	15 s
5	 Plank	2 × 20 s	15 s
6	 Single-leg balance	2 × 20 s per leg	
7	 Small jump, stable landing	2 × 5	20 s
8	Progressive accelerations	3 runs	walk back

2 EXPLOSIVENESS · JUMPS AND SPRING

15-20 min

30	 Broad jumps and triple jump (broad jumps)	3-4 × 3	75 s
15	 Lateral bound with stable landing	3 × 5 per leg	45 s

3 EXPLOSIVENESS · SPEED AND CHANGES OF DIRECTION

15-20 min

17	 Braking	4-6 runs	60 s
23	 Reactive starts	4-6 runs	60 s

4 CORE AND PREVENTION

5-8 min

19	 Dead bug	2-3 × 8 per side	30 s
20	 Y-T-W	2-3 × 8	30 s
21	 Balance with a ball	2 × 30 s per leg	20 s

5 COOL-DOWN

5 min

2 minutes of walking, then light stretches of 20 to 30 seconds, without forcing: hip flexors, quads, hamstrings, calves, chest and shoulders.

Session C

1 WARM-UP

10-12 min

1	Light jog and running drills	3 min	
2	Forward lunge with trunk rotation	6 per side	
3	Walking hip opener	8 per side	
4	Glute bridge	2 × 10	15 s
5	Plank	2 × 20 s	15 s
6	Single-leg balance	2 × 20 s per leg	
7	Small jump, stable landing	2 × 5	20 s
8	Progressive accelerations	3 runs	walk back

2 EXPLOSIVENESS · JUMPS AND SPRING

15-20 min

22	Box jump	3 × 4	90 s
10	Pogos	3 × 15	45 s

3 EXPLOSIVENESS · SPEED AND CHANGES OF DIRECTION

15-20 min

23	Reactive starts	6-8 runs	60 s
31	20 m sprint	3-4 runs	2 min

4 CORE AND PREVENTION

5-8 min

24	Single-leg glute bridge	2-3 × 10 per leg	30 s
25	Copenhagen plank (knee version)	2-3 × 15 s per side	30 s
26	Shoulder external rotation	2-3 × 12 per arm	30 s

5 COOL-DOWN

5 min

2 minutes of walking, then light stretches of 20 to 30 seconds, without forcing: hip flexors, quads, hamstrings, calves, chest and shoulders.

Weeks 6-7 · Intensity

Less volume, more speed: every rep at maximum quality. Effort 7-8 out of 10.

Explosiveness only: the focus moves to speed and changes of direction. The jumps stay, with fewer sets, so you do not lose what you have built.

Session A

1 WARM-UP

10-12 min

1	Light jog and running drills	3 min	
2	 Forward lunge with trunk rotation	6 per side	
3	 Walking hip opener	8 per side	
4	 Glute bridge	2 × 10	15 s
5	 Plank	2 × 20 s	15 s
6	 Single-leg balance	2 × 20 s per leg	
7	 Small jump, stable landing	2 × 5	20 s
8	Progressive accelerations	3 runs	walk back

2 EXPLOSIVENESS · SPEED AND CHANGES OF DIRECTION

15-20 min

31	20 m sprint	4-5 runs	2 min
12	 10 m starts	4-6 runs	75 s
23	 Reactive starts	4-6 runs	60 s

3 EXPLOSIVENESS · JUMPS (MAINTENANCE)

15-20 min

11	 Squat jump (maximum height)	2-3 × 3	90 s
32	 Drop jump (level 3) (levels 1 and 2: squat jump)	2 × 3	90 s

4 CORE AND PREVENTION

5-8 min

5	 Plank	2-4 × 30 s	30 s
13	 Side plank	2-3 × 20 s per side	20 s
14	 Nordic hamstring curl	2-3 × 4	60 s

5 COOL-DOWN

5 min

2 minutes of walking, then light stretches of 20 to 30 seconds, without forcing: hip flexors, quads, hamstrings, calves, chest and shoulders.

Session B

1 WARM-UP

10-12 min

1	Light jog and running drills	3 min	
2	Forward lunge with trunk rotation	6 per side	
3	Walking hip opener	8 per side	
4	Glute bridge	2 × 10	15 s
5	Plank	2 × 20 s	15 s
6	Single-leg balance	2 × 20 s per leg	
7	Small jump, stable landing	2 × 5	20 s
8	Progressive accelerations	3 runs	walk back

2 EXPLOSIVENESS · SPEED AND CHANGES OF DIRECTION

15-20 min

18	5-10-5 shuttle	3-5 runs	90 s
17	Braking (then re-accelerate over 5 m)	4-6 runs	75 s
23	Reactive starts	4-6 runs	60 s

3 EXPLOSIVENESS · JUMPS (MAINTENANCE)

15-20 min

15	Lateral bound with stable landing	2 × 4 per leg	60 s
30	Broad jumps and triple jump (triple jump)	2 × 3	90 s

4 CORE AND PREVENTION

5-8 min

19	Dead bug	2-3 × 8 per side	30 s
20	Y-T-W	2-3 × 8	30 s
21	Balance with a ball	2 × 30 s per leg	20 s

5 COOL-DOWN

5 min

2 minutes of walking, then light stretches of 20 to 30 seconds, without forcing: hip flexors, quads, hamstrings, calves, chest and shoulders.

Session C

1 WARM-UP

10-12 min

1	Light jog and running drills	3 min	
2	 Forward lunge with trunk rotation	6 per side	
3	 Walking hip opener	8 per side	
4	 Glute bridge	2 × 10	15 s
5	 Plank	2 × 20 s	15 s
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7	 Small jump, stable landing	2 × 5	20 s
8	Progressive accelerations	3 runs	walk back

2 EXPLOSIVENESS · SPEED AND CHANGES OF DIRECTION

15-20 min

23	 Reactive starts	6-10 runs	60 s
31	20 m sprint	3-4 runs	2 min
18	 5-10-5 shuttle	2-3 runs	90 s

3 EXPLOSIVENESS · JUMPS (MAINTENANCE)

15-20 min

10	 Pogos	2 × 10	45 s
22	 Box jump	2 × 3	90 s

4 CORE AND PREVENTION

5-8 min

24	 Single-leg glute bridge	2-3 × 10 per leg	30 s
25	 Copenhagen plank (knee version)	2-3 × 15 s per side	30 s
26	 Shoulder external rotation	2-3 × 12 per arm	30 s

5 COOL-DOWN

5 min

2 minutes of walking, then light stretches of 20 to 30 seconds, without forcing: hip flexors, quads, hamstrings, calves, chest and shoulders.

Week 8 · Taper

Repeat sessions A, B and C from weeks 6-7 doing **half the sets**, at the same intensity. You will start the season with your club in top shape.

- **Explosiveness:** No drop jumps this week.

The exercises

In the order of the numbers used in your sessions.



Important: watch each exercise's animation before doing it. Tap the eye next to its name. The animation shows what the text cannot: the exact position, the direction of the movement, the rhythm and the footwork. Do not just read the program, especially for an exercise you do not know: this is what makes every session effective and safe.

1 Light jog and running drills

On a **curved treadmill** (non-motorised, curved: you drive the belt yourself), if your gym has one: light jog, then running drills (high knees, butt kicks). Otherwise: drills on the spot or in the gym's open space: 5 minutes of high knees, butt kicks and side shuffles.

Key points: Start slowly, then gradually pick up the pace.



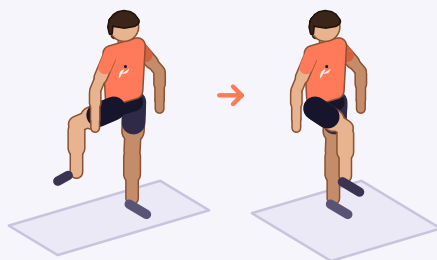
2



Forward lunge with trunk rotation

Take a big step forward, lower into a lunge, then turn your trunk towards the front leg. Come back and switch legs.

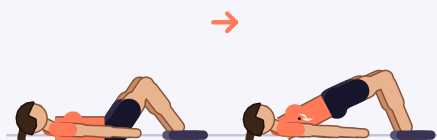
Key points: Front knee above the ankle, slow rotation.



3 Walking hip opener

As you walk, lift your knee out to the side as if stepping over a fence, bring it round in front of you at the same height, and put your foot down one step further. Switch legs.

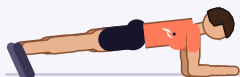
Key points: Upright trunk, big circle with the knee.



4 Glute bridge

On your back, knees bent, feet on the floor, lift your hips until shoulders, hips and knees are in line, then lower.

Key points: Squeeze your glutes at the top, do not arch your lower back. Also contract your pelvic floor (as if holding in urine): it protects against leaks, especially for women and older people.



5 Plank

On your forearms and toes, body in a straight line from head to heels.

Key points: Squeeze your glutes and abs, breathe normally.

Easier: Knees on the floor.



6 Single-leg balance

On one foot, knee slightly bent, arms relaxed: hold the position without moving. To progress: close your eyes, then stand on a cushion.

Key points: The knee stays over the foot, the pelvis level.



7 Small jump, stable landing

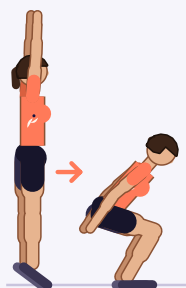
Small jump on the spot, land softly on both feet and hold the position for 2 seconds.

Key points: Land on the balls of your feet, knees bent and in line with your toes: they never cave inwards. In the air, pull your toes up towards your shins (locked ankle), ready for the landing.

8 **Progressive accelerations**

On a **curved treadmill** (non-motorised, curved: you drive the belt yourself), if your gym has one: 3 accelerations of 5 seconds, faster each time. Otherwise: 3 accelerations of 10 seconds on an assault bike (air bike) or a rowing machine.

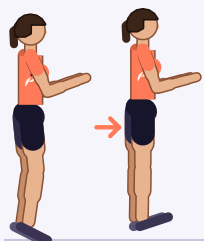
Key points: Relaxed, shoulders loose.



9 Stable landing (snap-down)

Standing, arms up, drive yourself down by pulling your arms back and land in a half squat on both feet. Hold for 2 seconds.

Key points: Knees in line with your toes, chest over your knees, silent landing.

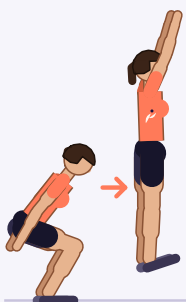


10 Pogos

Small quick jumps on the spot, legs almost straight: your ankles do the bouncing.

Key points: Shortest possible ground contact. In the air, pull your toes up towards your shins (locked ankle), ready for the landing.

Easier: Lower jumps, slower rhythm.

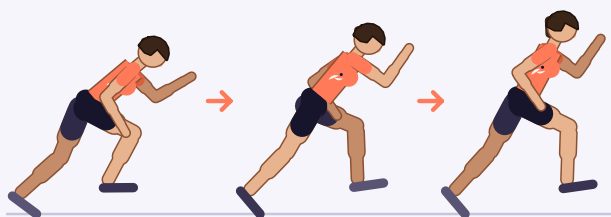


11 Squat jump

Lower into a half squat, pause for one second, then jump as high as you can. Stable landing.

Key points: Push hard into the floor, arms helping. In the air, pull your toes up towards your shins (locked ankle), ready for the landing.

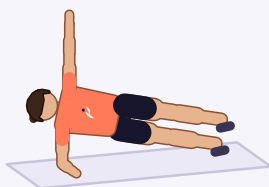
Easier: Without the pause.



12 10 m starts

On a **curved treadmill** (non-motorised, curved: you drive the belt yourself), if your gym has one: standing starts, 3 seconds flat out. Otherwise: 10 m starts in the gym's open space or outside.

Key points: Short, powerful first steps, arms driving back.



13 Side plank

On your side, on one forearm and the edge of your foot, body in line, hips high.

Key points: The hips do not drop.

Easier: Knees on the floor.

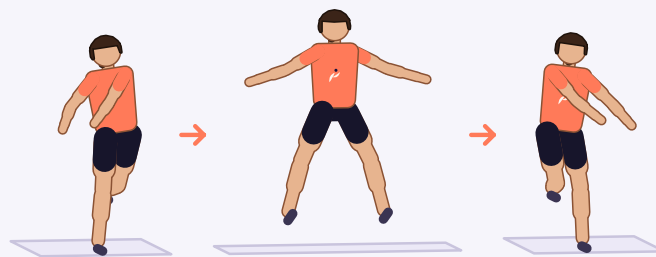


14 Nordic hamstring curl

Kneeling on a mat, feet anchored under a loaded bench, under wall bars or held by another person, lean forward as slowly as possible, body straight. Catch yourself with your hands, then push back up with your hands.

Key points: Hips extended: the body stays straight from the knees to the head.

Easier: Shorter descent.

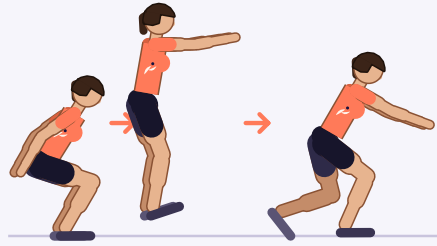


15 Lateral bound with stable landing

On one leg, jump sideways onto the other leg and hold for 2 seconds, like a skater.

Key points: The standing knee stays in line on landing. In the air, pull your toes up towards your shins (locked ankle), ready for the landing.

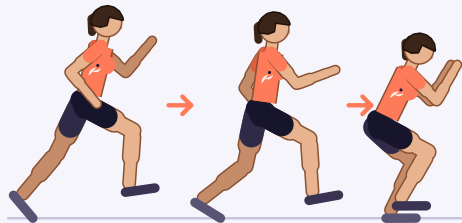
Easier: Shorter jump, the free foot touches the floor to help.



16 Single-leg landing

Small hop forwards (then sideways, then diagonally), land on one leg, hold for 3 seconds.

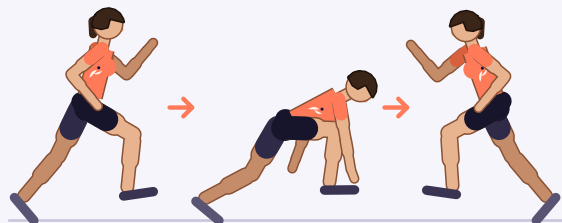
Key points: Land softly, knee in line with your foot. In the air, pull your toes up towards your shins (locked ankle), ready for the landing.



17 Braking

Sprint 10 m, then come to a complete stop in 3 steps, in a low defensive stance.

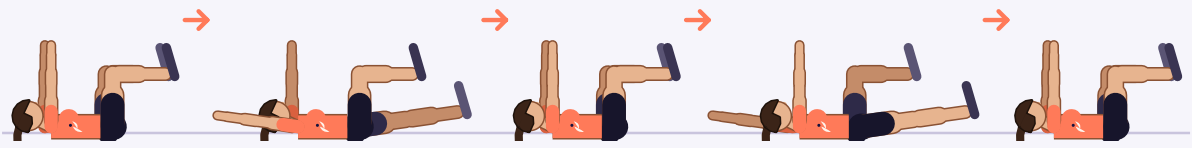
Key points: Low centre of gravity, wide base, knees in line. Never brake with straight legs: bend your knees to absorb, otherwise the impact goes into your joints.



18 5-10-5 shuttle

Start in the middle: 5 m to the right (touch the line), 10 m to the left (touch), back to the middle.

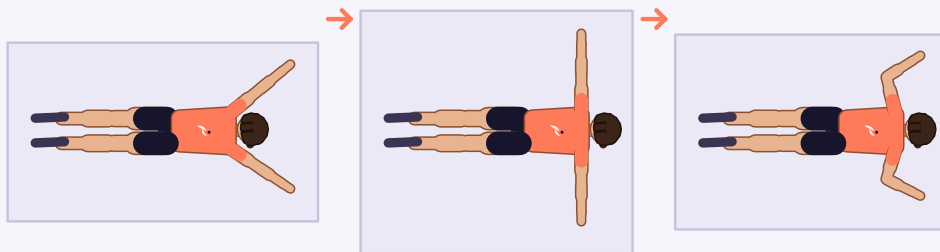
Key points: Get low before each change of direction, push off with the outside leg.



19 Dead bug

On your back, arms straight up towards the ceiling, knees bent at 90°. Extend one arm and the opposite leg without touching the floor, then switch sides.

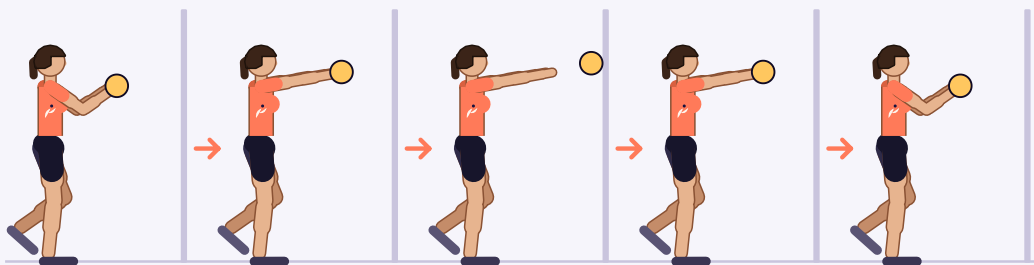
Key points: Your lower back stays pressed to the floor.



20 Y-T-W

Lying face down, forehead on a towel. Lift your arms off the floor to draw three letters with your body: Y (arms straight, diagonally above your head), T (arms out to the sides), then W (elbows bent, pulled in close to your ribs). Hold each letter for 2 seconds, squeezing your shoulder blades.

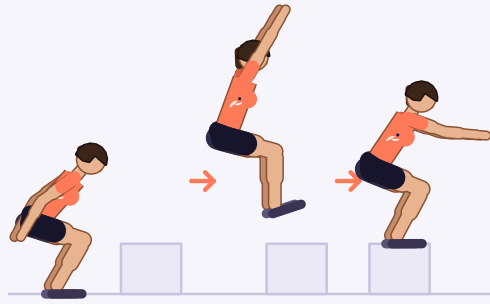
Key points: Thumbs towards the ceiling, no arching.



21 Balance with a ball

On one leg, on a bosu or a wobble board, throw a ball against a wall and catch it.

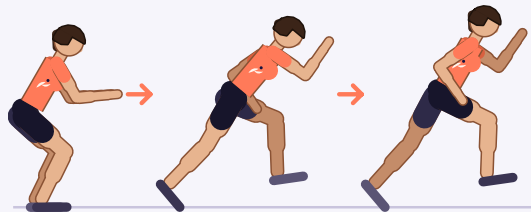
Key points: The standing knee stays in line.



22 Box jump

Jump onto a plyo box, land softly, step back down.

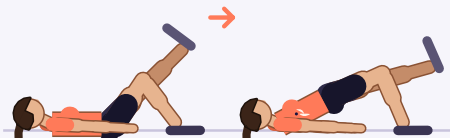
Key points: Jump high, not far. Stepping down protects your tendons. In the air, pull your toes up towards your shins (locked ankle), ready for the landing.



23 Reactive starts

Start on a partner's signal (clap, voice) or react to a dropped ball, from different positions: facing forward, facing backward, side shuffling.

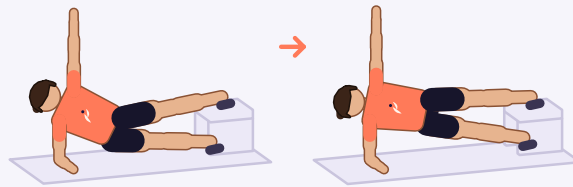
Key points: React, don't guess.



24 Single-leg glute bridge

Like the glute bridge, with one leg straight in the air.

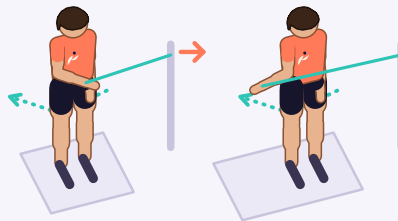
Key points: The pelvis stays level. Also contract your pelvic floor (as if holding in urine): it protects against leaks, especially for women and older people.



25 Copenhagen plank

On your side, on your forearm, top leg resting on a bench (at the knee, or at the foot to make it harder). Lift your hips and hold the position.

Key points: Body in line: the inside of the top thigh does the work.



26 Shoulder external rotation

On a cable set at elbow height (or with a band): elbow tucked in and bent at 90°, move your forearm outwards, then come back slowly.

Key points: The elbow does not move, 2 seconds on the way back.

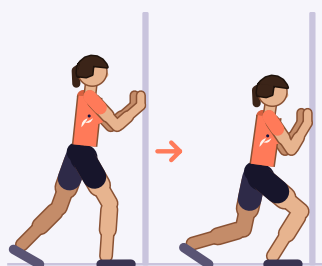
Easier: Without a band.



27 90/90 hip mobility

Seated on the floor, hands on the floor behind you, feet flat and wider than your hips, knees up. Let both knees drop to the same side into the 90/90 position: front leg bent at 90° in front of you, back leg bent at 90° out to the side. Bring the knees back up through the middle and over to the other side, like windscreen wipers.

Key points: Upright trunk, slow movement. Only go as far as your hips allow, pain-free.



28 Ankle mobility at the wall

Facing a wall, foot 10 cm away, drive your knee forward to touch the wall without lifting your heel.

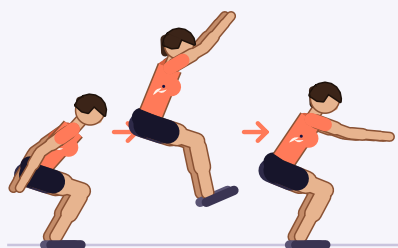
Key points: Heel glued to the floor. Move your foot back if it is easy.



29 Upper back rotation

On all fours, hands under your shoulders. Rotate your upper back as you reach one arm towards the ceiling, following your hand with your eyes, then bring it back down and do the same with the other arm.

Key points: The pelvis does not move.



30 Broad jumps and triple jump

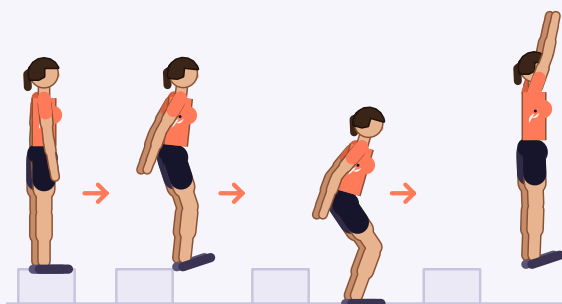
Standing long jump from both feet, stable landing. Triple jump: three jumps in a row, right foot, left foot, then land on both feet.

Key points: Arms swinging forward, controlled landing. In the air, pull your toes up towards your shins (locked ankle), ready for the landing.

31 **20 m sprint**

On a **curved treadmill** (non-motorised, curved: you drive the belt yourself), if your gym has one: 5-second sprint flat out. Otherwise: 20 m sprint in the gym's open space or outside, or else 6 seconds flat out on an assault bike.

Key points: Relaxed, shoulders loose.



32 Drop jump (level 3)

Step off a low box (20-30 cm) and, as soon as your feet touch the floor, bounce up as high as you can.

Key points: Very short contact. Only if your landings are perfect. In the air, pull your toes up towards your shins (locked ankle), ready for the landing.